Viktor Petukhov

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Education

New Economic School *Sep 2024 – Jul 2026*
- M.A. in Economics, *cum laude*
- GPA: 4.99/5.3; Rank: 3/50

Joint Program Higher School of Economics & New Economic School *Sep 2020 – Jul 2024*
- B.A. in Economics, *cum laude*
- GPA: 8.54/10.0; Rank: 13/65

Research Interests

Development Economics (Conflict, Religion); Political Economy (Autocracies); Applied Microeconomics;

Research Experience

Research Assistant *Moscow, Russia*
Prof. Ozgur Evren (New Economic School) *Sep 2026 – Present*
- This project aims to build a theoretical model in the intersection of literature on (self-)selection into politics, information markets, political campaigns, and economic growth

Research Assistant *Moscow, Russia*
Prof. Marta Troya-Martinez (NES) and Prof. Andrea Matranga (Uni Torino) *Aug 2026 – Present*
- Collect, classify and encode NYT article data for a project on Mafia.

Research Intern *Moscow, Russia*
Laboratory of Stochastic Analysis and its Applications (HSE) *Sep 2023 – Jun 2024*
- Collected and organized data for research projects in stochastic analysis

Research Assistant *Moscow, Russia*
Prof. Alexander Tarasov (HSE) and Prof. Alina Ozhegova (Aalto University) *Jan 2023 – Jul 2023*
- Collected data through web scraping with Selenium; cleaned, managed, and conducted preliminary analysis of the resulting datasets using Python and Stata

Teaching Experience

Graduate Teaching Assistant *Moscow, Russia*
New Economic School (NES) *Sep 2025 – Present*
- Teaching assistant for Mathematical Economics I–II and Microeconomics IV

Undergraduate Teaching Assistant *Moscow, Russia*
Higher School of Economics (HSE) *Sep 2021 – Jun 2024*
- Teaching assistant for Stochastic Processes, Macroeconomics II, and Calculus I

Leadership and Service

Teacher, Caregiver, and Summer Camp Manager *Rybinsk, Russia*
NGO 'Educational Center of the Rybinsk Diocese of the Russian Orthodox Church' *Aug 2021 – Present*
- Organize summer camps for orphans and children from low-income and single-parent families

Awards and Fellowships

University *2020–Present*
- Awards for outstanding performance in Economic Growth and Economic Theory (Class of 2026)
- NES Excellence Master's Fellowship (AY 2025/26)
- NES Scholarship for High Academic Achievement (Modules 3–5, AY 2024/25)
- Outstanding Teaching Assistant Award (2024)

High School *2018–2020*
- Moscow Medal for Special Academic Achievement (2020)
- Russian Olympiad for Schoolchildren: Economics (2020) and German Language (2018–2020)

Skills

Languages: Russian and German (native); English (fluent); French (intermediate); Spanish (basic)
Programming and Data: Stata; Python (pandas, Selenium, PyTorch); R; SQL
Research Methods: Causal Inference, DiD, IV, RDD, Experimental Designs
Software: Microsoft Office (Word, Excel, Powerpoint), LaTeX

Research Projects

Reelection Concerns versus Monetary Incentives *M.A. thesis*
Advisor: Prof. Marta Troya-Martinez
- Develop a model of implicit and explicit incentives for local politicians and test its predictions using a staggered difference-in-differences design based on a legal reform in Mexico

Trade Relationships and UN-Voting over the Russian-Ukrainian Conflict *B.A. thesis*
Advisor: Prof. Michele Valsecchi
- Use instrumental-variable strategies to study the effect of grain-import dependence on countries' voting alignment with Russia in UN resolutions

The Cost of Uneducated Children *Family Economics*
Instructor: Prof. Hosny Zoabi
- Model the quantity–quality tradeoff with education externalities, showing that policies aimed at reducing costs of bearing children can reduce human capital through adverse equilibrium shifts

An OLG Model of Conflict and Production *Economic Growth*
Instructor: Prof. Hosny Zoabi
- Build an OLG conflict-production model showing that capital–labor complementarity can generate poverty traps and complicate the effects of foreign aid

Dutch Disease in the Military Sector *Natural Resources*
Instructor: Prof. Gerhard Toews
- Use Bartik-style exposure and continuous-treatment staggered difference-in-differences to show that defense procurement raises local employment, income, and rents beyond military hiring

Do Religious Leaders Matter? *Political Economy*
Instructor: Prof. Ruben Enikolopov
- Use bishop transitions from 2000 to 2025 and staggered difference-in-differences, finding no robust effect on regional vote shares for Vladimir Putin

Churches and Development in Russia *Development Economics*
Instructor: Prof. Michele Valsecchi
- Instrument for church presence using clergy deportations in 1939, finding limited development effects aside from suggestive changes in specific criminal offenses

Deterrence Overstretch *Game Theory*
Instructor: Prof. Dimitry Dagaev
- Model resource-constrained deterrence and test its predictions with UCDP/PRIO data, finding mixed evidence that military overstretch encourages opportunistic conflict